

from the Metal Category for the window sill and Metal_Embossed for the doors and the windows. Looks better right?

Though the Material Library offers a wide range of textures, sometimes they are just not enough. In such a case you can always make a texture by using a picture, say a jpeg file. There are loads of textures available on the net for free.

So download a texture, say for the walls of the house. Now click **Create Material** to open the Create Material Dialog.

In the Create Material dialog you will find the preview screen on the top-left. Choose a name for your texture and enter it in the text box. First, click the button in the Texture area next to the text field. Browse to select the texture file. The Opacity bar allows you to make your textures semi-transparent or opaque. The Color section allows you to change the colour of your texture using one of the four colour pickers: RGB (Red-Green-Blue), HSL (Hue-Saturation-Lightness), HSB (Hue-Saturation-Brightness) and Color Wheel colour pickers. Experiment with different colours to see how the material retains its texture but the colour changes. To restore the original image, Press the Reset Color button below the Colorize checkbox. Press **OK** when you are done.

Apply the texture on the walls. Notice how the picture is tiled on the surface to give it a uniform texture look. Also notice the dimensions given while creating a new texture. By default, Google SketchUp resizes the texture image to 4" x 4". A smaller size may make the texture look like tiny dots when zoomed out. A larger size may make the picture being tiled apparent. Experiment with these dimensions to see which one suits your model the best. But how can you change the dimensions after you have applied the texture? Surely creating another material again isn't the most practical option. For this, we have the Edit Tab.

Choose the Edit Tab to see properties of the material currently selected. Notice that most of the options are same as the ones available when you were creating a new texture, which means you can always edit the properties after trying them out on your model. Now try changing the dimensions of the texture. See the difference in having a dimension smaller (left wall) and larger (right wall) than the default dimensions.